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# My Brain Won't Let Me Start.

The ADHD brain-hack pack for the woman who's  
tired of feeling lazy when she's anything but.

# You're not lazy. Your brain runs on different fuel.

You know exactly what to do. You *want* to do it. And still you sit there, frozen, scrolling, while a simple task glares at you — then you crash into a shame spiral about why you "can't just do the thing." You're not broken and you're not lazy. You have a brain that runs on interest, urgency, novelty, and challenge — not on "you should."

That gap between knowing and doing isn't a willpower failure. It's how an ADHD-style brain is wired: it needs a hook, not a lecture. "Try harder" never worked because effort was never the problem — *starting* is. This is a pack of brain hacks built for how you actually work, so you can start, finish, and drop the shame.

## THE RULE THAT UNLOCKS IT

Stop trying to do the task. Trick yourself into *starting* it — tiny, timed, with a hook. Starting is the entire wall. Once you're moving, momentum does the rest. Every hack here is just a different way to get you across that first 2 minutes.

## STEP 1

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# The 2-minute start ritual

Starting is the hardest part for us — so make starting embarrassingly easy. Run this exact sequence:

- 1 **Shrink it till it's silly.** Not "do the laundry" — "carry the basket to the machine." Not "clean the kitchen" — "rinse one cup." The goal is motion, not finishing. Make the first step so small it's stupid to say no.

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- 2 **Set a 10-minute timer.** Tell yourself you can quit when it rings. You usually won't — because starting was the wall, and you just climbed it. Permission to stop is what makes you start.

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- 3 **Body-double it.** Do it next to someone — in person, on a video call, or even a "study with me" video. Or narrate it out loud. Another presence tricks the ADHD brain into gear. This is the single most powerful hack here.

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- 4 **Stack a reward.** Coffee, a song, an episode — *after* the timer, not before. Give your brain the dopamine it's actually hunting for, on the other side of starting.

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## STEP 2

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# Make any task ADHD-proof

Boring tasks don't get done — not because you're weak, but because your brain needs a hook. Add one:

- **Pair it.** Match a dull task with a podcast, music, or a phone call. Never just the boring thing alone — that's a recipe for not doing it.

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- **Make it visible.** Out of sight = out of mind for ADHD. One sticky note, one whiteboard, one open tab. Not twelve — twelve is invisible too.

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- **Add novelty.** New spot, new pen, race the timer, do it standing up. Newness wakes the brain up. The same boring system stops working the second it's boring.

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- **Borrow urgency.** "I'll do it before the kettle boils." Tiny self-imposed deadlines beat "someday" every time.

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- **Lower the bar on purpose.** A messy done beats a perfect never. B-minus is a finish line. Perfectionism is just procrastination in a nice outfit.

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### STEP 3

## When your brain lies to you

Your ADHD brain tells you very convincing lies to avoid discomfort. Learn them, and call them out in the moment:

#### THE LIE

"I have plenty of time, I'll do it later."

#### THE TRUTH

Time blindness. "Later" never comes. Do the 2-minute version NOW.

#### THE LIE

"It's too big, I can't even start."

#### THE TRUTH

You're looking at the whole thing. Shrink it to one stupid-small step.

#### THE LIE

"I'll remember to do it."

#### THE TRUTH

You won't. If it's not written down or visible, it doesn't exist. Capture it instantly.

#### THE LIE

"I work better under last-minute pressure."

#### THE TRUTH

You work *only* under pressure — and it's wrecking you. Manufacture early, gentler urgency instead.

## STEP 4

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# Beat time blindness

You can't feel time passing — so put it outside your head where you can see it:

- **Use a visible timer or clock.** Watch the minutes move. Don't trust your inner clock; it lies constantly.
- **Set alarms for transitions, not just events.** "10 minutes till we leave" is the alarm that actually saves you — not the one for when you're already late.
- **Add a buffer.** Whatever you think it'll take, add half again. You're not slow — you chronically under-estimate.
- **Build one launch pad.** Keys, bag, charger, shoes live in ONE spot by the door. End the daily frantic search that makes you late and frazzled.

### THE EXTERNAL BRAIN

Stop trying to hold it all in your head — your head is the worst place for it. Timers, alarms, sticky notes, one list. Externalize everything. That's not a crutch; it's the accommodation your brain was always owed.

# Your brain isn't broken. It's just different.

Say them until you believe them:

- I'm not lazy. I have a brain that needs different tools — and now I have them.
- A messy, late, done thing still counts. Done is the goal, not perfect.
- Struggling to start is not a moral failure. It's a wiring difference.
- I can be proud of small wins without shrinking them.
- I'll work *with* my brain, not against it, from now on.

## DO THIS RIGHT NOW

Don't finish reading and drift off. Pick the one task glaring at you, shrink it to a 2-minute version, set a 10-minute timer, and start. You can quit when it rings. You won't — and you'll have proof you can move even when your brain says you can't.

# Don't do the list. Do the next two minutes.

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Shrink it, time it, body-double it, reward it. Catch the lies. Externalize the time. You were never lazy — you just needed tools built for your brain instead of someone else's. Now you have the whole pack. Go start your one thing. The timer's the only motivation you need.

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